

to the delivery of dramatic speech in **pitch** and rhythm; often used for dialogue and exposition of the plot between **arias** and choruses.

Romantic

The cultural epoch heralded in music by Beethoven, which dominated the 19th century.

rondo

A piece of music based on a recurring theme with interspersed material; follows a form such as ABACADAE.

scale

A series of notes that define a tune and, usually, the **key** of the piece. Different scales give music a different feeling and “color.”

semitone

The smallest musical interval between notes in Western **tonal** music. There are two semitones in a whole note and 12 semitones in an **octave**.

serialism, serial music

A system of **atonal** composition developed in the 1920s by Arnold Schoenberg and others, in which fixed sequences of music are used as a foundation to create a